The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

14th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Lacuna (फ़ासला)

Meaning: An unfilled space or gap, especially a missing portion in a manuscript, text, or idea.
Synonyms: Gap, omission, void, deficiency
Antonyms: Continuity, completeness, fullness
Example: The lacuna in the policy left many citizens confused about their rights.

2. Abrogation (निराकरण)

Meaning: The repeal or abolition of a law, right, or agreement.
Synonyms: Repeal, annulment, cancellation, termination
Antonyms: Enactment, establishment, approval, validation
Example: The abrogation of the outdated law was welcomed by the public.

VOCABULARY

3. Intractable (जटिल)

Meaning: Hard to control or deal with.
Synonyms: Stubborn, difficult, unmanageable
Antonyms: Manageable, compliant, flexible
Example: The intractable nature of the conflict made negotiations extremely challenging.

4. Peril (खतरा)

Meaning: Serious and immediate danger.
Synonyms: Hazard, risk, jeopardy
Antonyms: Safety, security, protection
Example: The villagers were in peril due to the approaching cyclone.

VOCABULARY

5. Belie (खण्डन करना)

Meaning: To contradict or show to be false.
Synonyms: Disprove, negate, refute
Antonyms: Confirm, verify, affirm
Example: His calm demeanor belied the nervousness he felt inside.

6. Rudiment (प्रथम तत्त्व)

Meaning: The first principles of a subject.
Synonyms: Basics, fundamentals, essentials
Antonyms: Details, complexities, intricacies
Example: Understanding the rudiments of mathematics is essential for advanced study.

VOCABULARY

7. Cognisant (परिचित)

Meaning: Having knowledge or being aware of.
Synonyms: Aware, conscious, mindful
Antonyms: Unaware, ignorant, oblivious
Example: She was cognisant of the risks involved in the project.

8. Frenzied (बेतहाशा उत्साहित)

Meaning: Wildly excited or uncontrolled.
Synonyms: Hectic, frantic, chaotic
Antonyms: Calm, orderly, composed
Example: The frenzied celebrations after the match lasted well into the night.

VOCABULARY

9. Astute (चतुर)

Meaning: Having or showing an ability to accurately assess situations or people and turn this to one's advantage.
Synonyms: Shrewd, sharp, perceptive
Antonyms: Foolish, naive, inept
Example: The team's success was largely due to the coach's astute strategies.

10. Exculpate (दोषमुक्त करना)

Meaning: To show or declare that someone is not guilty of wrongdoing.
Synonyms: Absolve, clear, acquit
Antonyms: Blame, accuse, incriminate
Example: The new evidence served to exculpate the defendant from the charges.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Bug out
Meaning: to leave a place or situation quickly, especially because of danger

2. Clog up
Meaning: to become or cause something to become blocked or obstructed

3. Ease off
Meaning: to gradually stop or become less

4. Hunt out
Meaning: to find (something) after searching for it.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Add insult to injury

Meaning: act in a way that makes a bad situation worse

2. The bottom falls out

Meaning: used to refer to the sudden collapse or failure of something

3. Hang on by fingernails

Meaning: to narrowly avoid problems or failure

VOCABULARY

4. Never in million years

Meaning: something is extremely unlikely or impossible

5. Pop the question

Meaning: to ask someone to marry you

Article for Reading

Indians abroad: on the 18th edition of the Pravasi Bharatiya Divas

At the inauguration of the 18th edition of the Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) last week, Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the Indian diaspora as India's "ambassadors to the world", having "seamlessly assimilated" into the local society, served the community, and contributed to India's growth and prosperity. The strength of the India-origin community worldwide of over 35 million — about 15.85 million NRIs and 19.57 million PIOs, who are foreign nationals — is their ability to adapt and thrive in different fields, including in politics, where Indian-origin people have become leaders of more than 30 other countries. Where they retain their Indian passports, the diaspora is known for its distinguished services in many professional spheres. The PBD's purpose is to celebrate this success and discuss issues of importance; President Droupadi Murmu handed out about 27 Pravasi Bharatiya Samman awards.

The event, which was first held in 2003, is organised around January 9, when Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa in 1915. The latest event, held in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, brought more than 3,000 delegates from across 70 countries, with much of the focus on how the diaspora can help in developing India (Viksit Bharat programme). The achievements of the Indian diaspora are, no doubt, a matter of pride for all Indians, but it is important that the event is not limited to a simple self-congratulatory or laudatory exercise. The issues for the diaspora, particularly for those who are still Indian nationals, are more acute now. The increase in far-right populist governments, particularly in the West, is making visa and entry conditions for Indians more difficult, and it is important for the government to address such issues.

Intractable global conflicts, especially in West Asia where more than nine million Indians live and work, are also putting lakhs of Indians in peril, and the PBD engagement would benefit from discussions between the community on how best to increase awareness and enhance safeguards for them. Given the broad spread of the diaspora, it is necessary to ensure that India's ties with its diaspora be inclusive, and non-partisan on political issues. Recent actions by the government to deny or revoke OCI cards for those perceived to be critical of the government bely this necessity. Above all, it is important to acknowledge that one of the biggest drivers of Indians migrating is the lack of economic opportunities within India. While there are no easy fixes for this, the loss to India of some of its most talented people must be counted, even as the country celebrates their incredible success and impact on the global stage.

Summary

The passage discusses the 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) event, highlighting its purpose of celebrating the achievements of the Indian diaspora, which comprises over 35 million people globally. Prime Minister Narendra Modi described the diaspora as ambassadors of India who contribute to India's growth and prosperity. The event in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, brought together delegates from over 70 countries, focusing on how the diaspora can assist in India's development. While celebrating the diaspora's success, the passage emphasizes the importance of addressing challenges they face, including stricter visa policies, safety concerns in conflict zones, and ensuring inclusive and non-partisan ties between India and its diaspora. It also highlights the need to address economic challenges in India that drive emigration, acknowledging the loss of talented individuals even as their global impact is celebrated.

The tone of the passage is analytical and balanced. It appreciates the achievements of the Indian diaspora and the importance of the PBD while critically examining challenges and areas for improvement in India's approach to its diaspora.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Which suggestion is made in the passage to improve the inclusiveness of India's ties with its diaspora?

a) Offering financial incentives for NRIs to return to India.
b) Avoiding partisan approaches to political issues.
c) Restricting diaspora contributions to non-political domains.
d) Increasing Pravasi Bharatiya Samman awards to over 50 annually.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What action by the government does the passage criticize in relation to the diaspora?

a) Imposing stricter visa policies for NRIs.
b) Increasing taxes on Indian-origin individuals abroad.
c) Reducing funding for diaspora-related initiatives.
d) Revoking OCI cards for critics of the government.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
Which issue does the passage emphasize as increasingly affecting the Indian diaspora, particularly in the West?

a) Declining professional opportunities abroad.
b) Rising anti-India sentiment among foreign governments.
c) Increasing visa and entry restrictions due to far-right populism.
d) Reduced access to Indian cultural events globally.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

The reforms needed in the MEA

India is on the rise, thanks to its consistent economic growth, political stability, and a bold, autonomous foreign policy. Whether it is the success of its G20 presidency, its strategic autonomy during the Russia-Ukraine conflict, its leadership in vaccine diplomacy during COVID-19, or its initiative in voicing the concerns of the Global South, India has estabalished itself as a major player in global affairs. However, with this increased global stature comes the need for an organisational framework that supports and sustains such ambitions. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) needs to keep pace with the demands of this new era and evolve to meet them. A critical examination of its staffing, structure, and operational approach reveals significant gaps that must be addressed urgently. The MEA is staffed with about 850 Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officers tasked with formulating and executing foreign policy across 193 embassies and consulates worldwide. While the annual intake of IFS officers has increased from 12-14 to 32-35 in recent years, it remains grossly inadequate. Comparatively, the U.S. has around 14,500 foreign service officers; the U.K., 4,600; and Russia around 4,500 officers.

Given the current intake rate, India would require decades to reach an optimal workforce of 1,500 officers. To address this challenge, the Ministry should consider lateral hiring and absorbing officers from other government services, including defence personnel with experience as defence attachés and academics specialising in international relations. Such recruitment should be subject to stringent selection criteria and probation periods to ensure quality. Additionally, consultants could be engaged for specialised roles. The current perception is that they are stop-gap appointees. The MEA's internal structure requires reorganisation to reduce fragmentation and improve coordination. It has many small divisions, especially territorial ones, which often result in inefficiencies. For instance, India's immediate neighbourhood, a declared priority in its foreign policy, is managed by four separate divisions: the PAI Division (Pakistan, Afghanistan, and Iran), the BM Division (Bangladesh and Myanmar), the Northern Division (Nepal and Bhutan) and the IOR Division (Sri Lanka, Maldives, and other nations in the Indian Ocean Region). While inputs from these are collated at higher levels, such fragmentation increases the risk of oversight and hinders cohesive regional engagement.

Similarly, the Gulf Division oversees eight Gulf countries, and the WANA Division handles the rest of West Asia and North Africa. Surprisingly, Iran and Türkiye, two pivotal nations in the region, do not fall under either division. Instead, Türkiye is managed by the Central Europe Division, while Iran falls under the PAI Division. Many similar misalignments highlight the need for restructuring and consolidating divisions to create a more efficient and integrated approach. While officers posted abroad enjoy substantial financial and administrative support, their counterparts in Delhi face significant challenges. Housing facilities have improved, but are still inadequate to accommodate the growing cadre. Furthermore, financial incentives and allowances for officers posted in India are limited, making domestic postings less appealing than foreign assignments. Providing better housing, medical coverage, and educational facilities for their families could work wonders for the morale of these officers. Also, offering financial incentives for Delhi postings could help. After all, this is where critical assessments are made, and key policies are formulated before being executed abroad.

Question 4:
What does the passage suggest as a solution to improve the morale of officers posted in Delhi?

a) Increasing the number of domestic postings.
b) Offering financial incentives and better housing facilities.
c) Allowing rotational postings between domestic and foreign roles.
d) Reducing the workload of officers in Delhi.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Which example from the passage illustrates misalignment in the MEA's internal structure?

a) Placement of Türkiye under the Central Europe Division.
b) Lack of a unified division for Africa and the Middle East.
c) Oversight of Gulf countries by the WANA Division.
d) Absence of a division dedicated to the Global South.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

- **Write an essay of 250 words about the contribution of the Aviation industry to our lives.**

The aviation industry has profoundly transformed the way we live, work, and connect with the world. As a cornerstone of globalization, it has significantly enhanced mobility, enabling people to travel across continents in mere hours, fostering cultural exchange, and bringing the global community closer together. One of the most impactful contributions of aviation is its role in economic development. By facilitating international trade, tourism, and business, it has created millions of jobs worldwide. The ease of transporting goods quickly and efficiently has allowed industries to thrive, especially those dependent on perishable products or time-sensitive deliveries. In emergencies, aviation has proven indispensable. It enables rapid response to natural disasters, delivering aid, medical supplies, and rescue teams to affected areas. Air ambulances and medical evacuation services have saved countless lives by providing swift access to healthcare in critical situations.

Socially, aviation has bridged the gap between people, allowing families and friends separated by vast distances to reunite. It has also opened doors for educational and professional opportunities abroad, empowering individuals to broaden their horizons.

However, the aviation industry is not without challenges. Its environmental impact, including carbon emissions, necessitates a shift towards sustainable practices. Innovations like fuel-efficient aircraft and alternative fuels are steps in the right direction.

In conclusion, the aviation industry has revolutionized modern life, fostering economic growth, social connectivity, and emergency responsiveness. As it continues to evolve, addressing sustainability will ensure its contributions remain positive and enduring for future generations.

- **Write a letter to the Minister of Education, highlighting the need for better infrastructure and resources in government schools. (150 words)**

[Your Address]
[City, State, Pin Code]
[Date]

The Honorable Minister of Education
[Ministry Address]
[City, State]

Subject: Need for Improved Infrastructure and Resources in Government Schools

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hope this letter finds you well. I am writing to draw your attention to the pressing need for better infrastructure and resources in government schools across the country.

Many government schools lack basic amenities such as clean drinking water, proper sanitation, and adequate classroom furniture. These conditions hinder students' ability to learn effectively and discourage parents from enrolling their children. Furthermore, the shortage of teaching materials, such as textbooks and digital resources, limits the scope for holistic education. Investing in well-maintained classrooms, libraries, and laboratories can create a conducive learning environment. Additionally, training teachers in modern teaching methods and integrating technology will prepare students for a competitive future.

I urge you to prioritize the allocation of funds and initiatives aimed at transforming government schools into centers of excellence. Your action can significantly shape the future of millions of children.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

Match the column

1. Add insult to injury	A. something is extremely unlikely or impossible
2. The bottom falls out	B. to narrowly avoid problems or failure
3. Hang on by fingernails	C. to ask someone to marry you
4. Drop the Ball	D. used to refer to the sudden collapse of something
5. Pop the question	E. act in a way that makes a bad situation worse

Answer:

1-e

2-d

3-b

4-a

5-c

Vocabulary

1. Lacuna:
2. Abrogation:
3. Intractable:
4. Peril:
5. Bely:
6. Rudiment:
7. Cognisant:
8. Frenzied:
9. Astute:
10. Exculpate:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage suggests that inclusiveness in India’s ties with its diaspora requires avoiding political partisanship.

Reference:

"Given the broad spread of the diaspora, it is necessary to ensure that India’s ties with its diaspora be inclusive, and non-partisan on political issues."

Incorrect Options:

a) Financial incentives for return are not mentioned.

c) Restricting contributions contradicts the aim of celebrating diaspora achievements.

d) Increasing awards is not suggested as a measure of inclusiveness.

2.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage specifically criticizes the government for actions like denying or revoking OCI cards of individuals perceived as critical of the government.

Reference:

"Recent actions by the government to deny or revoke OCI cards for those perceived to be critical of the government bely this necessity."

Incorrect Options:

a) Visa policies for NRIs are not discussed in this context.

b) Taxes on Indian-origin individuals are not discussed.

c) Funding reductions for initiatives are not mentioned.

3.
Ans: c
Explanation:
The passage highlights the challenges posed by far-right populist governments in the West, which are making visa and entry conditions more difficult for Indians.

Reference:
"The increase in far-right populist governments, particularly in the West, is making visa and entry conditions for Indians more difficult..."

Incorrect Options:

a) The passage does not mention declining professional opportunities abroad.
b) While political challenges are hinted at, no direct mention of anti-India sentiment exists.
d) Cultural events are not discussed as a concern in the passage.

4.
Ans: b
Explanation:
The passage emphasizes that better housing, financial incentives, medical coverage, and educational facilities for families can significantly boost the morale of officers posted in Delhi.

Reference:
"Providing better housing, medical coverage, and educational facilities for their families could work wonders for the morale of these officers. Also, offering financial incentives for Delhi postings could help."

Incorrect Options:

a) Increasing domestic postings is not mentioned.
c) Rotational postings are not suggested as a solution for morale.
d) Workload reduction is not discussed.

5.
Ans: a
Explanation:
The passage highlights the oddity of Türkiye being managed by the Central Europe Division rather than a relevant territorial division like the WANA or Gulf Division.

Reference:
"Surprisingly, Iran and Türkiye, two pivotal nations in the region, do not fall under either division. Instead, Türkiye is managed by the Central Europe Division, while Iran falls under the PAI Division."

Incorrect Options:

b) The passage does not mention a unified division for Africa and the Middle East.
c) Gulf countries are managed by the Gulf Division, not the WANA Division.
d) A division for the Global South is not discussed.

NIMISHA BANSAL

EXCLUSIVE SUBSCRIPTION

- ACCESS TO ALL COURSES (PERFECTION, GRAMMAR GRANTH, ERRORS
- Live+ Recorded Sessions
- Class PDF's
- Basic To Advance level
- Best Courses Till Date

Price : ~~₹ 2499~~
₹

USE CODE _____

MAKAR SANKRANTI/PONGAL OFFER

TURN DREAMS INTO OFFER LETTERS!

FLAT 40% OFF ON ALL PRODUCTS!

- ONE PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION
- ALL EDUCATORS EXCLUSIVE
- YES MOCK SUBSCRIPTION
- TARGET BATCH

USE CODE: SAFALTA

OFFER VALID TILL 16TH JANUARY

YOUR BANK JOB IS ONE STEP AWAY!

yes OFFICER

PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION

ALL EDUCATOR COURSES

ALL BANK EXAM 2024 PRELIMS+MAINS

ENGLISH

QUANT

REASONING

GENERAL AWARENESS

FOUNDATION + HIGH LEVEL COURSES

USE CODE

JOIN TELEGRAM CHANNEL

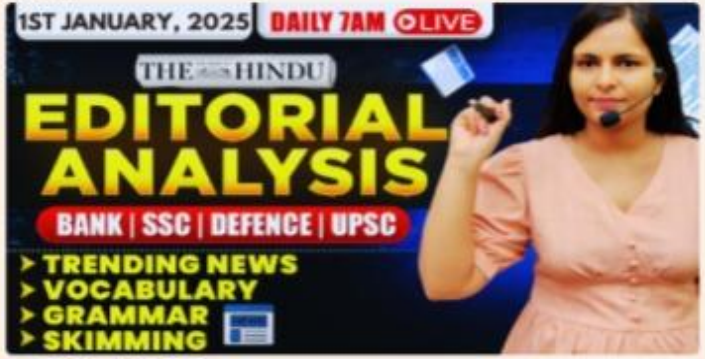
ENGLISH WITH NIMISHA BANSAL

@NimishaMam

English with Nimisha Bansal
452 824 subscribers

YouTube
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal

✅One Premium Subscription
USE CODE - SAFALTA
https...



30K 08:00

Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

CONTENT - NIMISHA BANSAL

@mamnimisha

Content- Nimisha Bansal
174 346 subscribers

annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.6K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
Perfection_Clas...t_Jan_2025.pdf
3.1 MB
Perfection Class Error detection with annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.9K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
PERFECTION CLA...T January.pdf
34.1 MB
PERFECTION CLASS NOTES 1K 14:14

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
EDITORIAL VOC...UARY 2025.pdf
2.7 MB
EDITORIAL VOCAB 1ST JANUARY 2025 1K 14:14